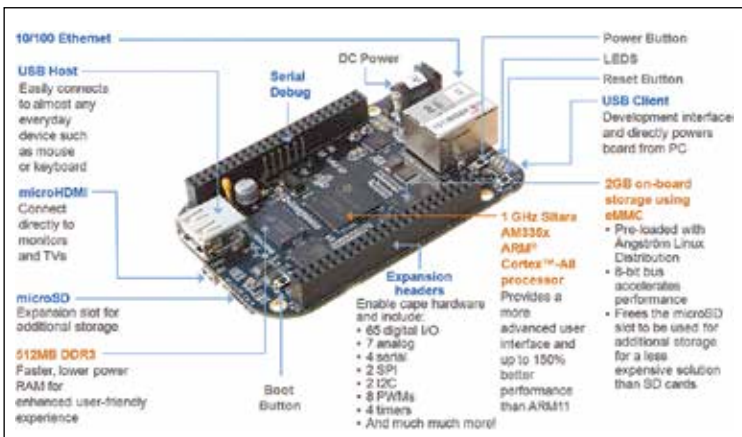


The Beaglebone

The original Beagleboard was launched late to the party in 2008. Only recently has its Beaglebone Black model from 2013 made serious strides towards sales and popularity. The original BeagleBoard was far more powerful in terms of its configuration while maintaining the small form factor. It allowed for advanced usage by hobbyists and makers for complex projects. However, the cost of the original BeagleBoard is at USD 125 with the BeagleBoard-xM variant at USD 145. This price barrier alone has prevented the BeagleBoard from finding a mass consumer base. The BeagleBone Black model is a stripped down version of the original device at the price of USD 45.

The BeagleBone has a faster ARM processor, DDR3 RAM, 2 GB storage, higher GPIO capability and Linux OS support. These upgrades alone more than make up for the ten dollar price difference between the two products. However, the BeagleBone Black only provides for a micro HDMI, while the Pi has HDMI and a composite display output. Another major deficiency in the BeagleBoard Black is its lack of Full HD resolution limited to a 1440x900 display. The BeagleBoard also lacks a separate audio out, unlike the Pi's 3.5 mm audio jack and draws 50 percent more power than the Pi to be operational.

Overall, the BeagleBoard does have its advantages. It is far easier to set-up than the Pi since it comes with basic peripherals such as a micro-USB cable and mini SD memory card. The Pi also lacks a pre-installed OS which isn't a problem in BeagleBoard given its onboard storage. The BeagleBoard only



The Beaglebone is a powerhouse of features for advanced makers.